CORE-08 | Therapist guide only

Reviewing change and choosing next steps

Core 08: goals, functioning, tools and an individualized plan for the way ahead.

Purpose of this unit

Help the client and therapist examine change, what helped and remaining needs. Use SES-S03 for the shared review; do not create a duplicate form under another name.

When to use

Review during treatment, before a focus change or before a professionally considered ending. Completing eight units is neither sufficient nor necessary for ending treatment. Return to goals and the personal baseline from ASM-A03.

Suggested review sequence

1. Explore which goals remain relevant and changes in preferences.

2. Compare examples of functioning and participation with the period and conditions chosen at the start.

3. Identify helpful tools, support and conditions, alongside what did not fit.

4. Make room for remaining difficulties and personal signs needing attention.

5. Choose continuation, adaptation or a return to a tool, and agree on reassessment timing.

Missing information and context

Do not reconstruct an undocumented baseline as though it were data. Changed circumstances, support and opportunities may affect comparison. The form provides no total score or recovery threshold.

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A review that makes room for difficulty

These fictional examples illustrate review questions, not expected treatment outcomes.

Group	What to explore
Children	The child asks for help in some situations but withdraws in others. Explore differences, what helped and desired practice, without treating a difficult day as erasing learning.
Adolescents	Starting tasks has changed, but relationship difficulties remain. Choose whether to keep the focus, set a new goal or request further support.
Adults	A meaningful activity returned only under certain conditions. Assess their availability and maintenance needs; do not assume the person should manage without help.
Older adults	One tool helps while another is inconvenient. Keep chosen tools and adapt reminders or support; retaining every sheet and tool is unnecessary.

When there is no change or things worsen

Reassess focus, suitability, circumstances and further assessment or care needs. Do not mark success based on attendance or completed forms. The plan must also reflect open issues.

Feedback on the working process

Ask about the relationship, pace, privacy and individual fit. Feedback can change the next plan, not just appear in a summary line.

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Maintaining tools and chosen support

CORE-08-P is a reminder and planning sheet, not an emergency plan or full risk assessment.

Group	Practical adaptation
Children	Use brief reminders of the situation, tool and helping person. Agree on an adult's role and preserve the child's wishes. Do not imply they must manage alone.
Adolescents	Choose what to keep and how to preserve privacy. Support arrangements must be clear and agreed, without automatic sharing with school or family.
Adults	Identify situations and conditions where the tool helps, alongside required resources and support. Maintenance does not require complete emotional control.
Older adults	Use adult language and a comfortable reminder method. Include a companion by need and choice, keeping personal decisions with the client as appropriate.

Personal signs and further exploration

Define familiar changes in functioning, routine or experience and what the client will do on noticing them. A sign is not a diagnosis. Urgent needs or significant distress require appropriate professional response, not waiting for the review date.

When the tool does not help

Allow adaptation and renewed exploration, not only more practice. Include support and routes to further contact as arranged within treatment.

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Deciding together what to continue

A period can be reviewed without ending treatment, with open questions explicitly retained.

A useful plan

Choose a few tried tools, a manageable step and desired support. Agree on review timing or conditions and follow-up responsibility. If ending is considered, clarify its meaning and routes back to care within the appropriate professional setting.

Choosing a pathway

Next steps may revisit a unit, change a goal, use another focused approach or end after joint assessment. The form or completed unit count does not automatically lead to a Specialized pathway.

Content status

All forms and guides are original drafts for professional and rights reviews. The catalog documents content production, not treatment outcomes or approvals already granted.

General sources for further reading

Beck Institute Cares: What Are CBT Sessions Like?
General background on goals, feedback and monitoring functioning.
https://cares.beckinstitute.org/about-cbt/what-are-sessions-like/

Beck Institute: CBT Relapse Prevention
General background on maintaining tools; not a protocol for this kit.
https://beckinstitute.org/blog/cbt-relapse-prevention/

Consulted: 03 Nov 2026. Sources neither license external forms nor validate the kit or its age adaptations.

Reviewer's name, role, date and versions reviewed:

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